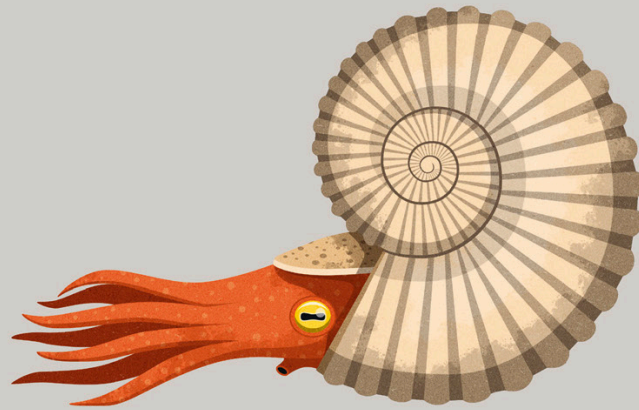


*In the past, people mistook dinosaur
fossils for the remains of dragons
and monsters.*



Fossil

Is this an animal made from gold? Yes and no. Sometimes, when an animal or plant dies it becomes trapped in sticky mud or sand. The soft parts rot away, leaving only the hard bones, shells, and stems. Over millions of years, minerals replace the materials that the hard parts are made from, turning them to fossils. Some fossils are made of a gold-coloured mineral called pyrite, making them shine!

Spiralling ammonites are often found as fossils. These are the swirling shells of sea creatures that once lived all over the world. Ammonites were related to the squashy squids and octopuses we have today, but they had a snail-like shell for protection.